

DID THE XIONG-NU SPEAK A YENISEIAN LANGUAGE?

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with interrupted root, and verbs with uninterrupted root (Kreinovich 1968a: 41, 97 ff.). Two simple examples:

verbs with uninterrupted root

-uŋ "see"

ba-t-tuŋ "he sees me" dæŋ-t-uŋ "he sees us"
ku-t-uŋ "he sees thee" kæŋ-t-uŋ "he sees you"
d-a-t-uŋ "he sees him" d-aŋ-t-uŋ "he sees them"
d-i-t-uŋ "he sees her"

verbs with interrupted root

daxij "mock"

daγ-wa-γ-ij "he mocks me" daγ-dæŋ-γ-ij "he mocks us"
daγ-ku-γ-ij "he mocks thee" daγ-kæŋ-γ-ij "he mocks you"
daγ-a-γ-ij "he mocks him" daγ-aŋ-γ-ij "he mocks them"
daγ-i-γ-ij "he mocks her"

Kott system seems to be simpler, but still quite complex. Simple example:

hama?-a-th-āk-ŋ "I love myself"
hama?-an-th-āk-u "thou lovest me"
hama?-an-th-āk "s/he loves me"
hama?-an-th-āk-an-oŋ "you love me"
hama?-an-th-āk-an "they love me"
hama?-u-th-āk-ŋ "I love thee"
hama?-a-th-āk-u "thou lovest thyself"
hama?-u-th-āk "s/he loves thee"
hama?-u-th-āk-an-toŋ "we love thee"
hama?-u-th-āk-an "they love thee"

The major difference between the Ket and Kott systems is that in Ket subject verbal agreement affixes are found as prefixes or infixes, while in Kott they are final suffixes concluding the verbal form. According to Georgii Starostin, it appears that Proto-Yeniseian system was much closer to Kott than to Ket (Starostin Georgii 1995: 158–160).

A verbal form in Proto-Yeniseian was built in the following way (Starostin Georgii 1995: 170):

preverb *k-, *t-, *p- + object marker *-w-, *-t-, *-k- + conjugation

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